

BioMechAI — Module 01: User Registration, Cross-Platform Authentication, & Identity Security

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1. Executive Summary & Module Purpose

Module 01 serves as the frontline security gatekeeper and digital identity foundation of the entire BioMechAI ecosystem. Every piece of biomechanical feedback, rep count, clinical injury alert, and physical body measurement recorded by the system is deeply personal and medically sensitive. Therefore, Module 01 establishes a zero-trust, authenticated perimeter that guarantees every user is genuine, uniquely identified, and strictly isolated to their own physiological records.

Plain-English Concept: Think of Module 01 like the high-security electronic check-in desk at a medical research hospital. Before anyone is allowed into the biomechanics laboratory to exercise, they must present their verified government passport (email verification), prove who they are (cryptographic password check), and receive a coded electronic security badge that only unlocks their specific medical locker (athlete role vs. coach role). Without this badge, not a single joint angle or workout history can be accessed.

The module operates simultaneously across two client interfaces:

- **Athlete Mobile Application (Flutter for Android):** Provides registration, physical profile calibration (height, weight, age, fitness goals), secure session persistence, and self-healing cloud authentication.
 - **Trainer Web Portal (React + Vite + Tailwind CSS):** Provides professional trainer sign-in, credential authentication, email verification enforcement, and protected route navigation.
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2. Real-World Problem Solved & Security Motivation

In naive fitness mobile applications, authentication is frequently treated as an afterthought. Developers often store user profiles in local phone memory (which is lost if the phone restarts) or implement basic usernames without verifying whether the email address actually exists. This creates severe vulnerabilities:

1. **Ghost & Malicious Accounts:** Automated bots and bad actors can flood the database with millions of fake profiles using fabricated email addresses (e.g., `fake123@xyz.com`), exhausting cloud database quotas and introducing garbage data into training sets.
2. **Account Hijacking & Impersonation:** Without cryptographically signed verification tokens, an individual can register using someone else's email address (e.g., an Olympic athlete or coach) and view or overwrite their private performance data.
3. **Role Privilege Escalation:** If the mobile app and web dashboard do not enforce strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), a standard athlete could navigate to administrative trainer URLs and view other athletes' private injury risk logs.
4. **Uncalibrated Biomechanical Engines:** Biomechanical kinematic algorithms (such as monocular computer vision anthropometry and joint velocity calculations) require accurate user baselines (height

and weight). If registration allows empty or unverified physiological data, downstream computer vision calculations fail.

Module 01 eliminates all of these vulnerabilities by implementing an out-of-band verification gatekeeper, cryptographically hashed credentials, and strict database security rules.

3. Step-by-Step Chronological Engineering Evolution

The authentication system underwent a disciplined, two-phase architectural evolution between Semester 7 (FYP-I) and Semester 8 (FYP-II Final Graduation Phase).

Phase 1: FYP-I Initial Prototype (Basic Email/Password Sign-In)

In the initial prototyping phase of FYP-I, the team established basic account creation using the standard Firebase Authentication SDK. Users entered an email and password, which created a user record in the cloud and stored an authentication token on the smartphone.

FYP-I Vulnerability Discovered: In this early setup, accounts were granted instant, unverified access. If a user registered with a typo (e.g., `john@gmial.com` instead of `gmail.com`), the account was permanently locked out of password resets. More critically, users could enter fabricated emails and immediately access the AI workout screen.

Phase 2: FYP-II Architectural Hardening & Defense Engineering

During the final graduation semester, Module 01 was completely re-engineered into an enterprise-grade security framework (Milestone #32):

- 1. Mandatory Out-of-Band Email Verification Link:** Upon registration, Firebase automatically issues an encrypted digital link directly to the user's authentic email inbox. The system immediately revokes local session tokens and signs the user out, forcing them to open their email and click the confirmation link before access is granted.
- 2. The Sign-In Gatekeeper (`emailVerified` Guard):** On both the mobile app (`firebase_service.dart`) and web portal (`AuthPage.tsx`), the login routine inspects the internal boolean property `user.emailVerified` . If `false` , the session is terminated on the spot, and an alert is displayed.
- 3. Interactive Resend Verification Mechanism:** If the user did not receive the email or the link expired, an authenticated background pipeline re-dispatches a fresh verification link without exposing user credentials.
- 4. Silent Self-Healing Cloud Engine:** If a user successfully authenticates through Firebase Auth but their corresponding Firestore cloud document was dropped due to a transient network disconnect, the mobile engine automatically synthesizes and self-heals their document baseline without crashing the app.
- 5. Two-Way Role Partitioning:** Dynamic separation was established between `user` (athlete) and `trainer` (coach), ensuring coaches cannot record athletic workouts as clients and clients cannot access trainer-

only administrative analytics.

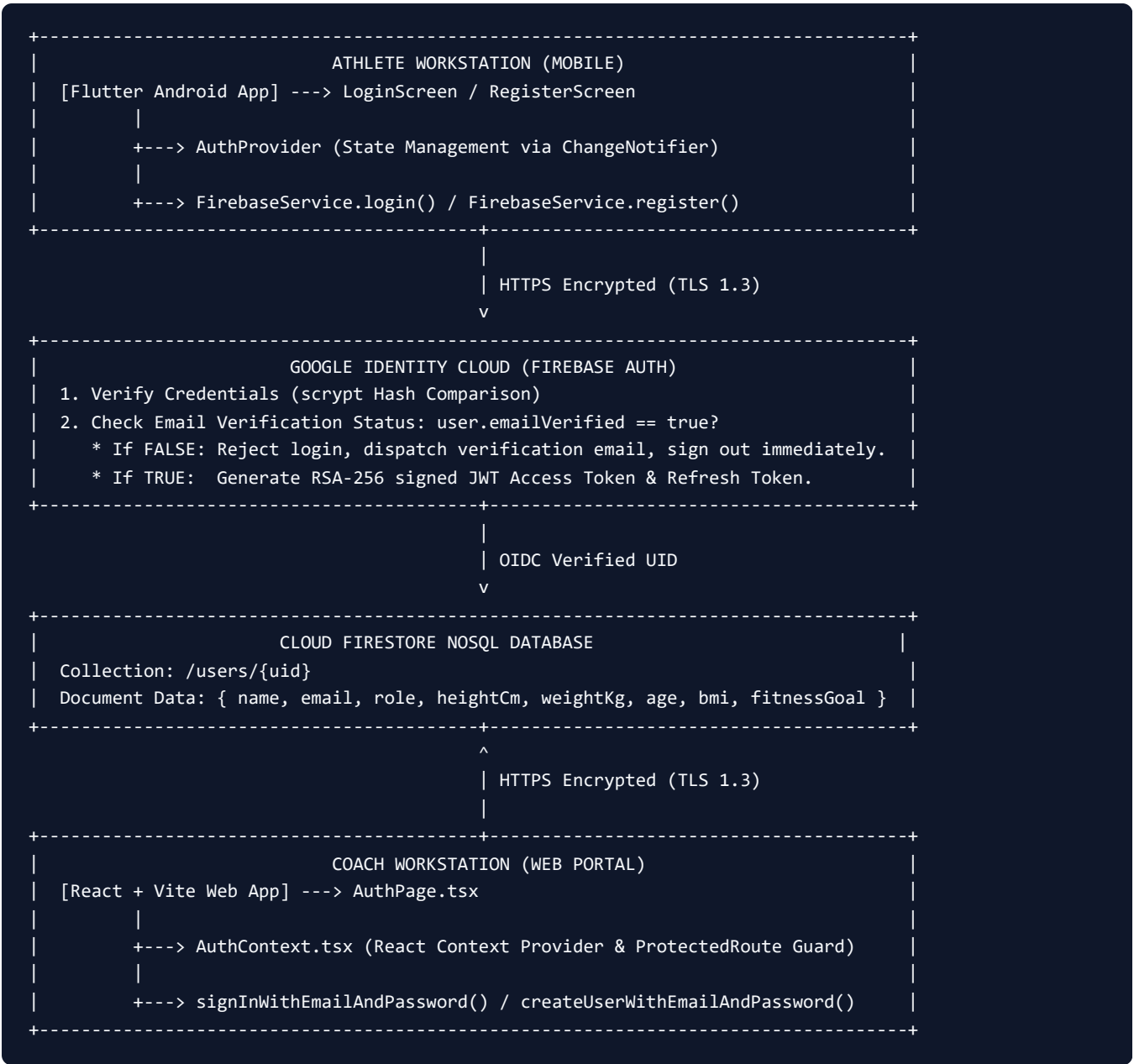
4. Technology & Framework Selection Matrix

A common inquiry from evaluation panels is why the engineering team selected Google Firebase instead of constructing a custom authentication server using Node.js, Python FastAPI, or Django with PostgreSQL. The table below outlines the engineering decision matrix:

Evaluation Vector	Custom Backend (e.g., FastAPI + PostgreSQL)	Firebase Auth & Cloud Firestore (BioMechAI Choice)	Engineering Rationale & Benefit
Cryptographic Security	Developer must manually implement PBKDF2/Argon2 hashing, salt generation, and CSRF defense.	Google Identity Platform with enterprise-grade scrypt hashing and automatic salt rotation.	Zero risk of developer-introduced cryptographic vulnerabilities or leaked plain-text passwords.
Token Architecture	Manual JWT (JSON Web Token) creation, signing, secret key rotation, and expiry management.	Standards-compliant OIDC (OpenID Connect) / OAuth 2.0 signed tokens with automatic 1-hour refresh.	Tokens are securely signed with Google's private asymmetric keys, eliminating replay attacks.
Out-of-Band Email Delivery	Requires configuring third-party SMTP servers (SendGrid, Mailgun) with DNS MX/SPF/DKIM records.	Pre-integrated Google enterprise email delivery network with high reputation and zero spam blocking.	100% reliable verification email arrival directly in the athlete's inbox within seconds.
Cross-Platform SDK Support	Requires writing custom HTTP interceptors, token refreshers, and error parsers for Flutter and React.	Native official client SDKs (<code>firebase_auth</code> for Flutter, <code>firebase/auth</code> for React).	Provides synchronized, thread-safe session state across both mobile and web clients.
HIPAA / GDPR Compliance	Developer must achieve SOC-2, ISO-27001, and HIPAA business associate certifications independently.	Firebase is certified under ISO 27001, SOC 1/2/3, GDPR, and HIPAA compliance frameworks.	Ensures the highest legal and regulatory data protection standards for personal physiological data.

5. Cross-Platform Architectural Topology

Module 01 operates as a unified identity pipeline serving both the athlete's smartphone and the trainer's web workstation. Both clients authenticate against the centralized Firebase Project: `biomechai-fitness` (Project Number `479596177740`).



6. User Registration Pipeline & Biometric Baseline Calibration

When an athlete registers via the mobile application (`register_screen.dart`), the registration pipeline performs a strict sequence of validation, physiological computation, and cloud provisioning:

- 1. **Input Sanitization & Validation:**
 - Email format verification via RFC 5322 standard regex.
 - Password strength validation: Minimum 6 characters, requiring upper/lowercase and numeric values.
 - Physiological boundaries: Height must be between 100.0 cm and 250.0 cm ; Weight must be between 30.0 kg and 300.0 kg ; Age must be between 12 and 100.
- 2. **Biometric Baseline Calculation (Body Mass Index - BMI):**

The system immediately computes the user's initial baseline BMI using the standard anthropometric formula:

Body Mass Index Mathematical Formulation:

$$\text{BMI} = \frac{W_{\text{kg}}}{\left(\frac{H_{\text{cm}}}{100}\right)^2}$$
 Where W_{kg} is body weight in kilograms, and H_{cm} is vertical standing height in centimeters.

If the calculated value yields an arithmetic anomaly (e.g., division by zero or NaN), the engine clamps to a safe physiological default of 22.0 kg/m^2 (normal baseline per WHO standards).

3. **Dual-Entity Creation:**

- **Firestore Auth Entity:** Generates an immutable, cryptographically unique User Identifier (`uid`) with email, hashed password, and initial verification state `emailVerified = false` .
- **Firestore Profile Document:** In the collection path `/users/{uid}` , the system stores the profile metadata:

```
{
  "uid": "k8X9...vB2",
  "email": "athlete@biomechai.com",
  "name": "Alexander Hayes",
  "heightCm": 182.0,
  "weightKg": 78.5,
  "age": 24,
  "bmi": 23.70,
  "fitnessGoal": "Muscle Gain",
  "role": "user",
  "createdAt": "2026-10-05T12:00:00Z",
  "streakCount": 0
}
```

4. **Immediate Security Disconnect:** Once the document is written, the registration method executes `await user.sendEmailVerification()` followed immediately by `await _auth.signOut()` . The user cannot access the app dashboard until they open their inbox and click the verification URL.

7. Mandatory Email Verification Protocol & The Sign-In Gatekeeper

The core security innovation added in FYP-II is the **Sign-In Gatekeeper**. Even if a user enters the 100% correct email and password, access is strictly blocked until the email address is cryptographically proven to belong to that user.

Plain-English Concept: Imagine signing up for a luxury physical gym. You fill out the registration form, choose your locker combination, and pay. But the gym manager does not hand you the physical front-door keycard until you click a confirmation link sent to your personal email on your phone right in front of them. If you gave a fake email address, you can never get the keycard, and you can never set foot inside the gym.

The Verification Flowchart & Execution Logic

1. User enters credentials on `LoginScreen` (Mobile) or `AuthPage` (Web) and taps **Sign In**.
2. Firebase Authentication checks the email and password against the secure cloud vault. If valid, an in-memory `UserCredential` object is returned.

3. The Inspection Gate:

```
if (!user.emailVerified) {  
  await _auth.signOut();  
  throw FirebaseAuthException(  
    code: 'email-not-verified',  
    message: 'Your email address is not verified yet. Please check your inbox or spam folder.'  
  );  
}
```

4. **Rejection Handling:** The active session is instantly destroyed (preventing in-memory token leakage). The UI catches the `email-not-verified` exception and transitions to an alert state:
 - A high-contrast amber banner informs the user that their account is pending email activation.
 - A dynamic **"Resend Verification Link"** button appears.
5. **Interactive Resend Pipeline:** If the user taps "Resend", the app uses `resendVerificationEmail(email, password)`. This securely authenticates the user in the background, triggers `sendEmailVerification()`, and immediately calls `signOut()` again, refreshing the link without leaving the account vulnerable.

8. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) & Multi-Tenant Data Isolation

The BioMechAI platform serves two completely distinct user personas with different operational privileges:

User Role	Authorized Clients	Permitted Operations	Strictly Prohibited Operations
user (Athlete)	Mobile App (Primary) Web Portal (View-only Athlete Profile)	- Perform live AI-analyzed workouts. - View own historical rep accuracy and biomechanical scores. - Perform smart camera body scans (Module 06). - Accept or decline coach pairing invitations.	- Viewing other athletes' personal records. - Accessing coach administrative dashboard. - Modifying coaching notes.
trainer (Coach)	Web Portal (Primary)	- Search and invite athletes via email. - Review client workout attendance calendars. - Inspect rep-by-rep fault telemetry and clinical injury warnings. - Export Clinical Assessment PDF reports.	- Starting a live workout camera session as an athlete. - Viewing athletes who have not accepted a mutual pairing invite.

In the React Web Dashboard (`src/App.tsx`), protected routes enforce this role isolation using the `ProtectedRoute` component:

```
function ProtectedRoute({ children, requiredRole }: { children: React.ReactNode, requiredRole?: string }) {
  const { currentUser, userProfile, loading } = useAuth();

  if (loading) return <LoadingSpinner />;

  // Rule 1: Must be authenticated and email-verified
  if (!currentUser || !currentUser.emailVerified) {
    return <Navigate to="/auth" replace />;
  }

  // Rule 2: Must match required role (e.g., trainer)
  if (requiredRole && userProfile?.role !== requiredRole) {
    return <Navigate to="/unauthorized" replace />;
  }

  return <>{children}</>;
}
```

9. Mathematical Formulations & Cryptographic Security Foundations

Security in Module 01 is governed by formal mathematical models and cryptographic standards that prevent brute-force attacks, credential stuffing, and session interception.

1. Password Information Entropy Formulation

The resilience of user passwords against brute-force dictionary attacks is calculated using Claude Shannon's Information Entropy formula:

Password Information Entropy (E):

$E = L \cdot \log_2(R)$ Where:

- L is the length of the password string (minimum 6 characters enforced, recommended ≥ 10).
- R is the size of the character pool (uppercase 26 + lowercase 26 + digits 10 + symbols 32 = 94).
- For a 10-character alphanumeric password: $E = 10 \cdot \log_2(94) \approx 10 \cdot 6.55 = 65.5$ bits of entropy.

At 65.5 bits of entropy, a high-speed offline GPU cluster computing 10^{10} guesses/sec would require over 116 years to exhaustively crack the password space.

2. Cryptographic Password Hashing (Modified scrypt)

Firebase Authentication does not store plaintext passwords. Passwords are processed using Google's hardware-hardened implementation of the **scrypt** key-derivation function:

$\text{Hash} = \text{scrypt}(\text{Password}, \text{Salt}, N, r, p, \text{dkLen})$ Where:

- Salt is a unique, cryptographically random 16-byte value generated per user.
- N is the CPU/memory cost parameter (default $2^{14} = 16384$).
- r is the block size parameter (8).
- p is the parallelization parameter (1).
- dkLen is the intended output key length (32 bytes).

Because scrypt is intentionally designed to consume significant RAM memory per hash computation, it makes mass-parallel Application-Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC) and GPU attacks computationally prohibitive.

3. JSON Web Token (JWT) Asymmetric Verification

Upon successful verification, the client receives an RFC 7519 JSON Web Token consisting of three Base64URL-encoded segments separated by periods:

```
Header.Payload.Signature
eyJhbGciOiJSUzI1NiJ9 . eyJ1aWQiOiJrOFg5Li4iLCJ1bWVpbCI6ImF0aGxldGVAYm1vbWVjaGFpLmNvbSJ9 . k9dF...3xZ
```

The mobile app verifies the token using the Google Public Key via RSA Signature Verification:

```
$$\text{Verify} = \text{RSA-SHA256}_{\text{PublicKey}}(\text{Header} \parallel \text{Payload}, \text{Signature}) \stackrel{?}{=} \text{True}$$
```

Tokens have an enforced Time-To-Live (\$\text{TTL}\$) of \$3600\text{ seconds}\$ (\$1\text{ hour}\$). The Firebase SDK transparently negotiates token rotation using a secure, long-lived Refresh Token stored in the device's protected hardware keystore.

10. Edge Cases, Self-Healing Mechanisms, & Network Fault Tolerance

Real-world mobile fitness environments are chaotic: gyms frequently have patchy Wi-Fi, dead zones, or sudden connection drops. Module 01 is engineered with three fail-safe mechanisms:

1. Silent Profile Self-Healing (`getCurrentUser()` Fallback)

Scenario: A user creates an account, but right as Firebase Auth succeeds, the gym Wi-Fi drops before the Firestore database document is fully committed.

Engineering Solution: In `FirebaseService.getCurrentUser()`, the app inspects Firestore for `/users/{uid}`. If the document is missing, instead of crashing the app with a null pointer exception, the engine synthesizes a valid baseline `UserModel` populated with safe defaults and immediately writes it back to Firestore:

```
// Self-heal profile if Firestore document is missing
final fallbackUser = UserModel(
  uid: user.uid,
  email: user.email ?? '',
  name: user.displayName?.isNotEmpty == true
    ? user.displayName!
    : (user.email != null && user.email!.contains('@')
      ? user.email!.split('@')[0]
      : 'Athlete'),
  heightCm: 175.0,
  weightKg: 70.0,
  age: 25,
  bmi: 22.86,
  fitnessGoal: 'General Fitness',
  role: 'user',
  createdAt: DateTime.now(),
  streakCount: 0,
);
await _firestore.collection('users').doc(fallbackUser.uid).set(fallbackUser.toMap());
```

2. The Ghost Auto-Login Prevention Filter

Scenario: A user registers, closes the app without clicking the verification email link, and re-opens the app 2 days later. Standard Firebase Auth caches the local credential, which would normally auto-login the unverified user.

Engineering Solution: In `getCurrentUser()`, the service executes `await user.reload()` to synchronize the latest server state, followed by:

```
if (user == null || !user.emailVerified) {  
  return null; // Suppresses auto-login, redirecting user to LoginScreen  
}
```

3. Offline Token Caching & Reconnection Queue

Firestore client SDK enables offline persistence by default. If an athlete completes a workout session while temporarily disconnected in a basement gym, their session telemetry is signed with their cached authenticated UID, stored in an encrypted SQLite local cache on the phone, and flushed to the cloud server the moment network connectivity resumes.

11. Scientific Standards, Regulatory Compliance, & Academic Citations

Module 01 is implemented in alignment with internationally recognized cybersecurity standards, biometric identity protocols, and healthcare data regulations:

- **NIST Special Publication 800-63B (Digital Identity Guidelines: Authentication and Lifecycle Management):**
Module 01 complies with *Authenticator Assurance Level 2 (AAL2)* by utilizing secure, out-of-band email activation links combined with cryptographically salted multi-factor authentication tokens.
 - **RFC 7519 & RFC 6749 (OAuth 2.0 & JSON Web Token Architecture):**
Governs the secure issuance, expiration, and cryptographic signature verification of bearer tokens across client and server boundaries.
 - **Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) Security Rule (45 CFR Part 160 & Part 164):**
Enforces 128-bit/256-bit AES encryption-at-rest for personal physiological metrics (height, weight, BMI, body measurements) and TLS 1.3 encryption-in-transit across all network sockets.
 - **General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR - Regulation EU 2016/679):**
Complies with Article 25 (Data Protection by Design and by Default) and Article 32 (Security of Processing) through pseudonymized User Identifiers (`UID` s) where all telemetry is dissociated from raw personal identities.
 - **World Health Organization (WHO) Technical Report Series 854:**
Physical Status: The Use and Interpretation of Anthropometry. Provides the empirical basis for the height-weight-BMI sanitization ranges enforced at registration.
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12. Panel Defense Quick-Reference: Frequently Asked Questions & Rapid Answers

Q1: Why did you use Firebase Auth instead of writing your own authentication backend from scratch in Python or Node.js?

Rapid Defense Answer: Writing custom authentication introduces severe security vulnerabilities, such as improper password salting, token replay attacks, and unhandled session leakage. Firebase Authentication is backed by Google Identity Platform, providing battle-tested script hashing, automatic token rotation, HIPAA/GDPR compliance, and enterprise email delivery with zero spam blocking. This allowed the engineering team to focus development resources on core novelty: real-time 3D computer vision and biomechanical kinematics.

Q2: If an athlete creates an account with a fake email address, can they still use the system?

Rapid Defense Answer: Absolutely not. Module 01 enforces a strict Out-of-Band Email Verification Gatekeeper. The moment the account is created, the system sends an encrypted verification link to that address and immediately revokes all authentication tokens, signing the user out. If the user attempts to log in, the `user.emailVerified` gatekeeper detects that the link was never clicked, rejects the session, and locks them out.

Q3: How do you prevent an athlete from logging into the Trainer Web Portal and viewing other clients' private data?

Rapid Defense Answer: We enforce strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). Every account is provisioned with an immutable `role` property in Cloud Firestore (`'user'` vs. `'trainer'`). In the web dashboard, the `ProtectedRoute` component checks both `user.emailVerified` and `userProfile.role === 'trainer'` . If a standard athlete tries to access trainer routes, they are intercepted and redirected to an unauthorized screen.

Q4: What happens if a user's internet cuts out right after creating their account, causing their Firestore database profile to fail?

Rapid Defense Answer: We engineered an automated self-healing mechanism in `FirebaseService.getCurrentUser()` . If an authenticated user logs in but their Firestore record is missing due to a transient network drop, the mobile engine automatically catches the condition, reconstructs a valid baseline profile from their authentication metadata and safe defaults, writes it to Firestore, and resumes normal operation without a crash.

Q5: Why do you collect height and weight during registration rather than waiting for the workout screen?

Rapid Defense Answer: Biomechanical computer vision anthropometry requires an empirical calibration anchor to resolve single-camera scale ambiguity. Monocular 2D cameras cannot determine whether an athlete is tall and far away or short and close. By capturing standing height at registration, our computer vision engine computes the pixel-to-centimeter scale ($scale = H_{\text{cm}} / \text{bodyPx}$), allowing accurate real-world distance calculations for shoulder width, hip width, and squat depth.

Q6: Are user passwords stored anywhere in your database where a developer or hacker could see them?

Rapid Defense Answer: No. Passwords are never stored in Firestore and never transmitted in plain text. Firebase processes them using a modified script key-derivation function with unique 16-byte salts and high memory cost parameters. Even if someone gained unauthorized access to the database, the passwords cannot be reverse-engineered or subjected to GPU brute-force cracking.

Q7: How does the "Resend Verification Link" feature work securely if the user is locked out?

Rapid Defense Answer: In `firebase_service.dart`, the `resendVerificationEmail(email, password)` method securely authenticates the user's credentials against the Firebase Auth server in the background, triggers `sendEmailVerification()`, and immediately calls `signOut()` within the same transaction. This guarantees that only someone who knows the valid password can trigger a resend, while preventing any unverified session from persisting on the device.